

Aspeed (5274.TWO)

Well positioned for a prolonged server upcycle; reiterate Buy with TP up to NT\$15,000

5274.TWO 12m Price Target: **NT\$15,000.00** Price: **NT\$11,320.00** Upside: **32.5%**

Robust long term server outlook driven by inference demand

Aspeed Chairman attended a keynote speech session on 17th March. In the meeting, Aspeed toned up its view towards the server industry growth and the long term growth outlook for BMC market. **Aspeed raised its BMC shipment TAM for 2030 to 65.77mn units (vs. 46.50mn units previously, implying c.41% upward revision),** mainly supported by a stronger general server demand spurred by AI related application. Management further breaks down general server BMC demand into 1) BMC for traditional general server and 2) BMC for AI-related general server. **While the traditional general server demand is expected to remain stable at 5-6% YoY growth, management now sees AI-related general servers to accelerate by growing 40% YoY in 2026.**

Furthermore, management is now forecasting BMC shipment TAM for AI-related general servers to reach 8.5mn units in 2026, with 45% growth in 2027 and 20% thereafter, aligning with growth rate expected for BMC demand for AI servers including AI ASICs. **Aspeed attributes this strength to the rise of Agentic AI workloads and the growing role of CPUs in handling inference tasks,** with a significant portion of demand driven by in-house designed ASIC CPUs from CSP customers.

Upbeat 2Q26 outlook; price hike starting 2Q26

The company also provided its 2Q26 guidance in the meeting. 2Q26 revenue guidance came in as an upside surprise with revenue of **NT\$3.4-3.6bn**, which was 7%/14% higher vs GSe/Bloomberg consensus (at the midpoint), and **translate to a 32% QoQ growth** at the mid point (vs midpoint of 1Q26 guidance). Margin wise, Aspeed is now guiding for 2Q26 GM of 67-68%, higher vs 1Q26 GM guidance of 66.5-67.5%.

To note, **management expects Aspeed to face a fiber glass**

BUY

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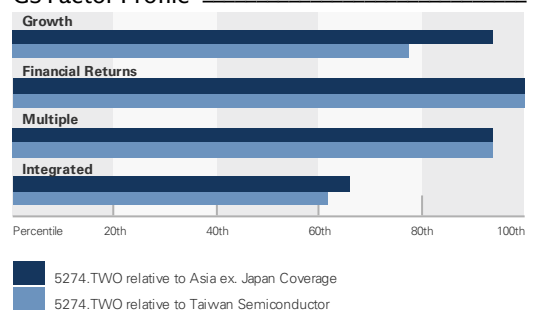
Key Data

Market cap: NT\$427.5bn / \$13.3bn
Enterprise value: NT\$417.6bn / \$13.0bn
3m ADTV: NT\$2.9bn / \$90.5mn
Taiwan
Taiwan Semiconductor
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (NT\$ mn) New	9,084.9	14,858.7	22,691.3	31,654.3
Revenue (NT\$ mn) Old	9,084.9	13,514.6	20,165.0	—
EBITDA (NT\$ mn)	4,984.4	8,756.1	14,094.9	20,035.8
EPS (NT\$) New	103.46	185.26	300.00	426.08
EPS (NT\$) Old	103.45	164.86	266.68	—
P/E (X)	44.2	61.1	37.7	26.6
P/B (X)	22.9	36.8	24.2	12.7
Dividend yield (%)	1.7	1.2	2.0	2.8
CROCI (%)	114.3	197.8	279.5	335.5
	12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E
EPS (NT\$)	31.69	34.92	44.04	52.04

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

Aspeed (5274.TWO)

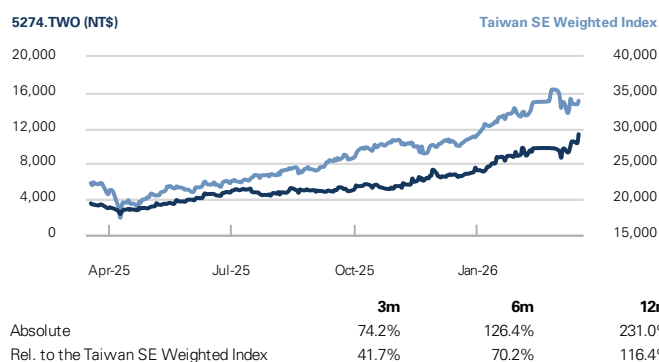
Rating since Mar 17, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	44.2	61.1	37.7	26.6
P/B (X)	22.9	36.8	24.2	12.7
FCF yield (%)	2.4	1.6	2.6	3.6
EV/EBITDAR (X)	33.7	47.7	29.2	19.8
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	33.7	47.7	29.2	19.8
CROCI (%)	114.3	197.8	279.5	335.5
ROE (%)	59.5	73.0	77.3	62.5
Net debt/equity (%)	(76.5)	(85.1)	(88.7)	(92.2)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	(76.5)	(85.1)	(88.7)	(92.2)
Interest cover (X)	693.8	833.9	1,360.5	1,961.1
Days inventory outst, sales	12.8	8.2	7.0	6.5
Receivable days	62.9	51.3	48.9	51.2
Days payable outstanding	181.1	163.1	149.3	142.3
DuPont ROE (%)	51.9	60.2	64.0	47.6
Turnover (X)	0.9	1.0	1.0	0.8
Leverage (X)	1.4	1.3	1.2	1.2
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (NT\$)	3,499.1	3,835.3	4,399.4	5,278.1
Average capital employed (NT\$)	1,881.2	1,759.6	1,869.6	2,312.7
BVPS (NT\$)	200.27	307.58	468.60	894.68

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	40.6	63.6	52.7	39.5
EBITDA growth	57.0	75.7	61.0	42.1
EPS growth	52.0	79.1	61.9	42.0
DPS growth	52.0	79.1	61.9	42.0
EBIT margin	51.3	56.4	60.8	62.5
EBITDA margin	54.9	58.9	62.1	63.3
Net income margin	43.2	47.1	50.0	50.9

Price Performance**Income Statement (NT\$ mn)**

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	9,084.9	14,858.7	22,691.3	31,654.3
Cost of goods sold	(2,906.2)	(4,545.3)	(6,531.4)	(9,048.5)
SG&A	(476.4)	(642.9)	(770.0)	(939.3)
R&D	(1,042.0)	(1,296.4)	(1,593.4)	(1,888.7)
Other operating inc./exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	4,984.4	8,756.1	14,094.9	20,035.8
Depreciation & amortization	(324.0)	(381.9)	(298.5)	(258.1)
EBIT	4,660.3	8,374.2	13,796.5	19,777.7
Net interest inc./exp.)	146.6	161.2	161.2	161.2
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	4,855.4	8,695.4	14,117.7	20,099.0
Provision for taxes	(927.6)	(1,692.2)	(2,777.1)	(3,991.9)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	3,927.8	7,003.2	11,340.6	16,107.1
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	3,927.8	7,003.2	11,340.6	16,107.1
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (NT\$)	103.46	185.26	300.00	426.08
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (NT\$)	103.46	185.26	300.00	426.08
EPS (basic, post-exception) (NT\$)	103.46	185.26	300.00	426.08
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (NT\$)	103.46	185.26	300.00	426.08
DPS (NT\$)	77.61	138.98	225.05	319.64
Div. payout ratio (%)	75.0	75.0	75.0	75.0

Balance Sheet (NT\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	5,788.3	9,890.6	15,711.9	31,198.4
Accounts receivable	1,642.1	2,532.0	3,543.1	5,340.2
Inventory	279.7	388.9	478.5	654.7
Other current assets	698.2	698.2	698.2	698.2
Total current assets	8,408.2	13,509.7	20,431.7	37,891.5
Net PP&E	409.0	233.2	144.4	99.5
Net intangibles	607.7	481.6	352.0	218.8
Total investments	208.9	208.9	208.9	208.9
Other long-term assets	699.8	699.8	699.8	699.8
Total assets	10,333.7	15,133.2	21,836.8	39,118.5
Accounts payable	1,679.7	2,382.6	2,959.3	4,093.9
Short-term debt	0.0	0.0	0.0	—
Short-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other current liabilities	763.9	803.9	843.9	883.9
Total current liabilities	2,443.6	3,186.5	3,803.1	4,977.8
Long-term debt	—	—	—	—
Long-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other long-term liabilities	319.3	319.3	319.3	319.3
Total long-term liabilities	319.3	319.3	319.3	319.3
Total liabilities	2,762.9	3,505.8	4,122.4	5,297.1
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	7,570.8	11,627.4	17,714.3	33,821.4
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Total liabilities & equity	10,333.7	15,133.2	21,836.8	39,118.5
Net debt, adjusted	(5,788.3)	(9,890.6)	(15,711.9)	(31,198.4)

Cash Flow (NT\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	3,927.8	7,003.2	11,340.6	16,107.1
D&A add-back	324.0	381.9	298.5	258.1
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	397.6	(296.2)	(524.1)	(838.7)
Other operating cash flow	(153.6)	—	—	—
Cash flow from operations	4,495.9	7,088.9	11,115.0	15,526.4
Capital expenditures	(274.1)	(40.0)	(40.0)	(40.0)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	(120.6)	—	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(394.7)	(40.0)	(40.0)	(40.0)
Repayment of lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(1,929.0)	(2,946.6)	(5,253.7)	—
Inc/(dec) in debt	0.0	—	—	—
Other financing cash flows	(43.2)	0.0	0.0	0.0
Cash flow from financing	(1,972.2)	(2,946.6)	(5,253.7)	0.0
Total cash flow	2,129.0	4,102.3	5,821.3	15,486.4
Free cash flow	4,221.8	7,048.9	11,075.0	15,486.4

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

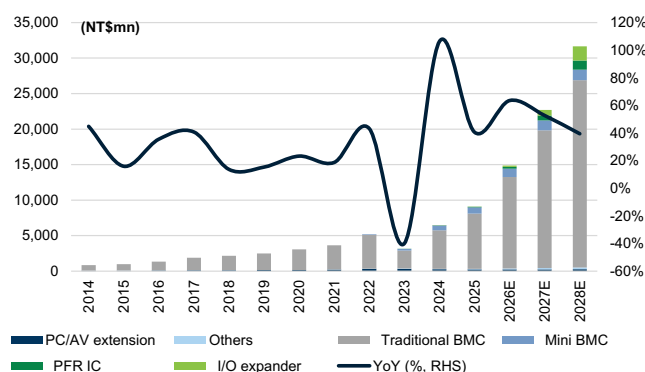
shortage in 1H26 and anticipates 2H26 revenue will be much higher vs. 1H26 as substrate bottlenecks ease following the qualification of a new E-glass supplier in Thailand. Management also noted a substrate price increase from vendors; however, Aspeed expects to pass through the higher cost to customers, thereby maintaining a healthy GM profile. As for 1Q26, the company maintained its guidance unchanged, indicating c.8.5% revenue QoQ growth. Net net, we are now modeling 1Q26/2Q26E revenue to grow by 43%/61% QoQ, and GM at 68.6%/69.0%.

Multi-year growth ahead

Looking ahead, we now expect Aspeed to deliver even stronger growth for 2026 and beyond, driven by **1)** market share gain from existing customers for the BMC business thanks to new server platform's migration to AST2700 from AST2600, with the lack of competitor's comparable solution, **2)** the faster ramp up of the new AST2700-series BMCs (AST2700/AST2750) stimulated by cyber security standard upgrade and the migration of DDR4 to DDR5; we expect AST2700 to begin ramping up in 2Q26, with approximately 70–80% higher pricing vs AST2600, **3)** new project ramp for mini BMC within existing customers, and **4)** volume ramp of new business lines including I/O expander and PFR IC, following new server platform migration with rising adoption of AST2700.

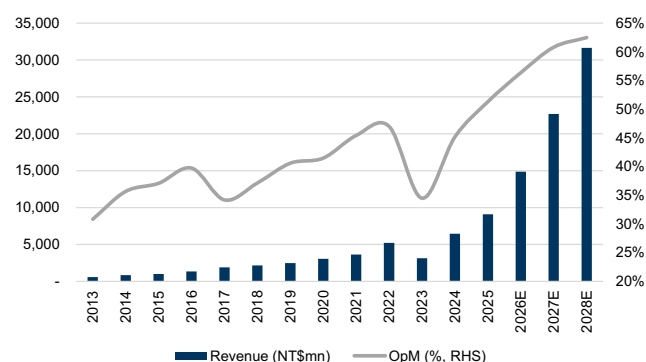
Overall, we now expect Aspeed to deliver a 64%/53% revenue YoY growth (vs 49%/49% YoY previously) in 2026/2027E with GM at 69.4%/71.2% (vs 68.9%/71% previously).

Exhibit 1: We expect Aspeed's revenue to accelerate over 2025–2028E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Clear OPM expansion trend as revenue accelerates



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings changes, valuation and risks

Forecast changes

We have revised up 2026/2027E earnings by 12.4%/12.5% to reflect 1) stronger 2Q26 guidance, 2) higher BMC price assumptions, and 3) upward BMC TAM revision. We also introduce our 2028E forecast in this report.

Exhibit 3: Earnings revisions

(NT\$mnn)	2026E			2027E			2028E		
	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)
Revenue	13,515	14,859	9.9%	20,165	22,691	12.5%	NA	31,654	NA
Gross profit	9,317	10,313	10.7%	14,312	16,160	12.9%	NA	22,606	NA
Op. income	7,508	8,374	11.5%	12,315	13,796	12.0%	NA	19,778	NA
Net income	6,232	7,003	12.4%	10,081	11,341	12.5%	NA	16,107	NA
EPS (NT\$)	164.86	185.26	12.4%	266.68	300.00	12.5%	NA	426.08	NA
GM	68.9%	69.4%	0.5%	71.0%	71.2%	0.2%	NA	71.4%	NA
OpM	55.6%	56.4%	0.8%	61.1%	60.8%	-0.3%	NA	62.5%	NA
NM	46.1%	47.1%	1.0%	50.0%	50.0%	0.0%	NA	50.9%	NA

(NT\$mnn)	2Q26E			3Q26E			4Q26E		
	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)
Revenue	3,258	3,607	10.7%	3,658	4,116	12.5%	3,647	4,188	14.8%
Gross profit	2,231	2,490	11.6%	2,522	2,860	13.4%	2,538	2,940	15.8%
Op. income	1,783	2,009	12.7%	2,065	2,369	14.7%	2,070	2,424	17.1%
Net income	1,467	1,665	13.5%	1,705	1,967	15.4%	1,743	2,051	17.7%
EPS (NT\$)	38.80	44.04	13.5%	45.10	52.04	15.4%	46.10	54.26	17.7%
GM	68.5%	69.0%	0.5%	68.9%	69.5%	0.5%	69.6%	70.2%	0.6%
OpM	54.7%	55.7%	1.0%	56.5%	57.6%	1.1%	56.8%	57.9%	1.1%
NM	45.0%	46.1%	1.1%	46.6%	47.8%	1.2%	47.8%	49.0%	1.2%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

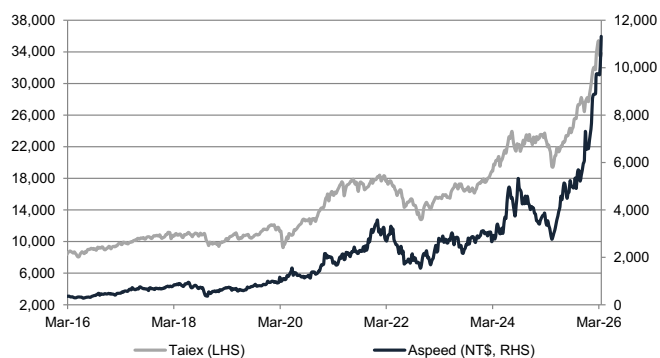
Maintain Buy with TP raised to NT\$15,000 from NT\$12,000

We raise our 12m TP to NT\$15,000 (from NT\$12,000 previously) and now based on 40x 2028E discounted P/E (vs. 45x 2027E P/E previously; inline with avg. 5-yr fwd P/E). Our target P/E is inline with the long-term 10-yr avg. fwd P/E. We apply this to our 2028E EPS, and discount it back to 2027E at a 13.6% CoE to arrive at our TP of NT\$15,000. Our key assumptions for CoE include: (1) 1.5x beta (sourcing Bloomberg), (2) a 4.25% risk-free rate (inline with GS house-view), and (3) a market risk premium of 6.25% (in line with our GS house view). Our new TP implies c.32.5% upside from the current share price, and we reiterate our Buy rating on Aspeed.

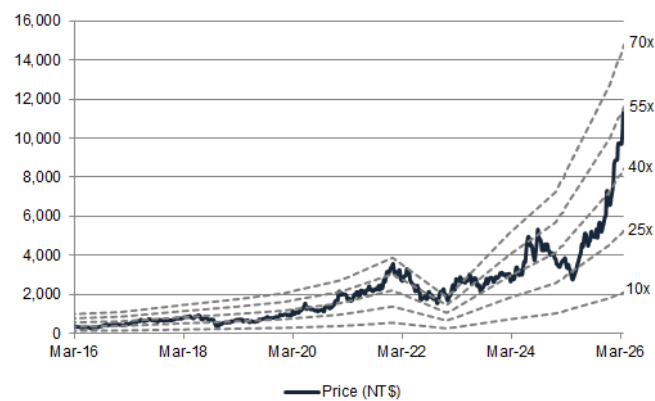
Exhibit 4: Aspeed: P&L overview

	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E	2026E	2027E	2028E
P&L											
Revenue	2,947	3,607	4,116	4,188	4,656	5,441	6,292	6,302	14,859	22,691	31,654
Gross profit	2,023	2,490	2,860	2,940	3,269	3,844	4,489	4,558	10,313	16,160	22,606
Operating profit	1,571	2,009	2,369	2,424	2,736	3,281	3,864	3,916	8,374	13,796	19,778
Net income	1,320	1,665	1,967	2,051	2,246	2,671	3,159	3,264	7,003	11,341	16,107
EPS (NT\$)	34.92	44.04	52.04	54.26	59.41	70.65	83.57	86.35	185.26	300.00	426.08
Margins (%)											
GM	68.6%	69.0%	69.5%	70.2%	70.2%	70.7%	71.3%	72.3%	69.4%	71.2%	71.4%
OpM	53.3%	55.7%	57.6%	57.9%	58.8%	60.3%	61.4%	62.1%	56.4%	60.8%	62.5%
NM	44.8%	46.1%	47.8%	49.0%	48.2%	49.1%	50.2%	51.8%	47.1%	50.0%	50.9%
YoY (%)											
Revenue	42.7%	60.6%	76.7%	71.4%	58.0%	50.8%	52.9%	50.5%	63.6%	52.7%	39.5%
Gross profit	47.9%	63.3%	77.3%	75.8%	61.6%	54.4%	56.9%	55.0%	66.9%	56.7%	39.9%
Operating profit	53.0%	69.7%	92.4%	99.1%	74.2%	63.3%	63.1%	61.5%	79.7%	64.8%	43.4%
Net income	48.9%	164.6%	62.0%	71.3%	70.1%	60.4%	60.6%	59.1%	78.3%	61.9%	42.0%
EPS	51.8%	164.5%	62.0%	71.2%	70.1%	60.4%	60.6%	59.1%	79.1%	61.9%	42.0%
QoQ (%)											
Revenue	20.6%	22.4%	14.1%	1.7%	11.2%	16.9%	15.6%	0.2%			
Gross profit	20.9%	23.1%	14.9%	2.8%	11.2%	17.6%	16.8%	1.5%			
Operating profit	29.0%	27.9%	17.9%	2.3%	12.9%	19.9%	17.8%	1.3%			
Net income	10.2%	26.1%	18.2%	4.3%	9.5%	18.9%	18.3%	3.3%			
EPS	10.2%	26.1%	18.2%	4.3%	9.5%	18.9%	18.3%	3.3%			

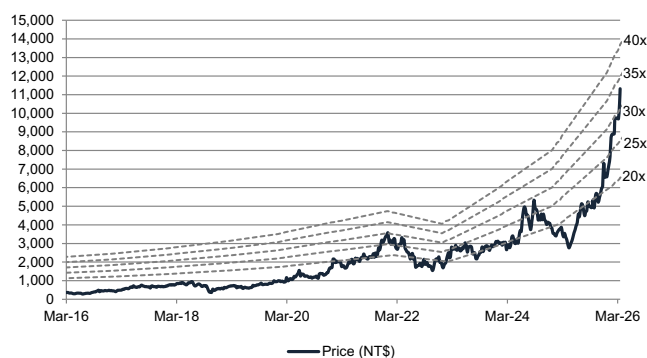
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Taiex vs. Aspeed

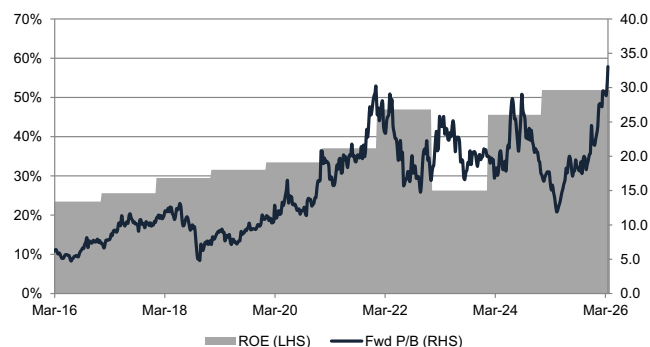
Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 6: Forward P/E

Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 7: Forward P/B

Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 8: P/B vs. ROE

Source: Bloomberg

Investment Thesis, Price Target Risks and Methodology

Investment Thesis - Aspeed (5274.TWO)

Aspeed is a leading Taiwan-based IC (integrated circuit) design company specializing in BMC (baseboard management controller) SoC, which is used to remotely monitor the physical state of servers. The company is the largest BMC supplier, with c.70% of the global BMC market share, and 90% of its total revenue comes from the BMC segment.

We like Aspeed as we expect its revenue/earnings CAGRs to further accelerate to 52%/60% in 2025-2028E (vs. 5.9%/4.9% during 2019-2023), driven mostly by AI server demand, especially started from 2025. Furthermore, we also expect server architecture changes will bring more business opportunities to Aspeed to drive up its TAM expansion within the server market. With more TAM expansion and more dollar content growth within the AI theme, we continue to see upside potential to its revenue and earnings growth. We have a Buy rating on the name.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Aspeed (5274.TWO)

Valuation: Our 12-month TP of NT\$15,000 is based on a target P/E of 40x (in line with its 10-year historical trading average) applied to our 2028E EPS, and discounted back to 2027E at 13.6% CoE. Our key assumptions for CoE include: (1) 1.5x beta (sourcing Bloomberg), (2) a 4.25% risk-free rate, and (3) a market risk premium at 6.25% (in line with our GS house view).

Key downside risks to our view and TP: 1) A softer-than-expected server market demand recovery, 2) slower-than-expected BMC penetration within AI servers, 3) intensifying market competition.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Evelyn Yu, Bruce Lu, Allen Chang and Ryan Huang, CFA, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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GS Factor Profile

The Goldman Sachs Factor Profile provides investment context for a stock by comparing key attributes to the market (i.e. our universe of rated stocks) and its sector peers. The four key attributes depicted are: Growth, Financial Returns, Multiple (e.g. valuation) and Integrated (a composite of Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple). Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple are calculated by using normalized ranks for specific metrics for each stock. The normalized ranks for the metrics are then averaged and converted into percentiles for the relevant attribute. The precise calculation of each metric may vary depending on the fiscal year, industry and region, but the standard approach is as follows:

Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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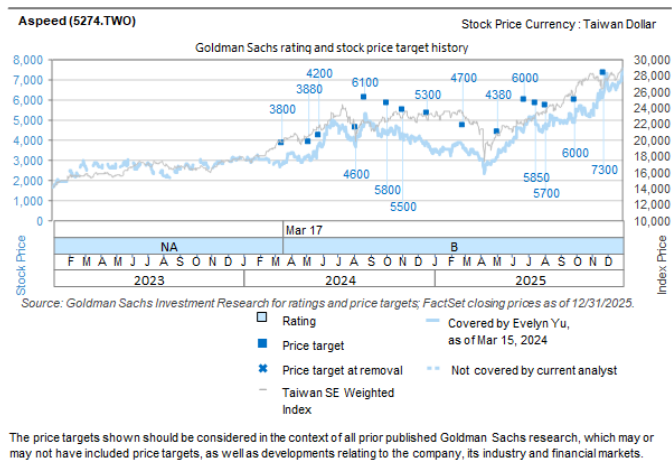
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